



WORKBOOK

Stop Overthinking

A practical workbook for getting out of your head and back into your life

Before you begin

Overthinking is sneaky, because it looks like responsibility. You are not ignoring the problem — you are thinking about it. Constantly. From every angle. At two in the morning.

But thinking about a problem and solving it are different things. Most overthinking goes round in circles: the same conversation replayed, the same decision weighed for the fortieth time, the same worst case imagined in slightly more detail.

This workbook is about breaking the loop. The techniques are simple and they are practical, but they only work if you actually use them — so each chapter ends with something to write down. Use a pen. Your head is the problem; paper is the way out.

- Read one chapter at a time. They are short on purpose.
- Do each exercise in writing — on the page, not in your head.
- Use the trackers and planner pages at the back every day.
- Print it at home, or open it in a tablet app that lets you write on PDFs.

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What overthinking actually is

Overthinking usually takes one of two shapes. Rumination looks backwards: going over what you said, what they meant, what you should have done. Worry looks forwards: rehearsing what might go wrong and how bad it could be.

Both feel productive. Both rarely are. A useful test is simple: after twenty minutes of thinking, are you any closer to a decision or an action? If the honest answer is no, you are not problem-solving. You are circling.

Naming it helps more than you would expect. “I’m ruminating” or “I’m worrying” turns an overwhelming fog into a pattern you can recognise — and patterns can be interrupted.

- Rumination replays the past; worry rehearses the future.
- The test: am I any closer to a decision?
- Label it when it happens: “This is overthinking.”

EXERCISE · SPOT YOUR LOOPS

What are the two or three topics your mind returns to most? For each, write whether it is mostly rumination (past) or worry (future).

FREE SAMPLE

That's the end of the sample

The full Stop Overthinking is 16 pages. Here is everything inside it:

- Chapter 1: What overthinking actually is
- Chapter 2: The two-question test
- Chapter 3: Give worry an appointment
- Chapter 4: Get it out of your head
- Chapter 5: Thoughts are not facts
- Chapter 6: Decide faster
- Chapter 7: Calm the body to calm the mind
- Chapter 8: When to get more support
- Worry log
- Thoughts parked for later
- Before bed

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